SOURCE SUMMARY · OCTOBER 26, 2026

22209 Susana Avenue: what the record says

> A disputed two-story house, two continued hearings and a later attached ADU. Council denied the neighbors' appeal, leaving project approval in place.

The simple explanation

Neighbors sought to protect Palos Verdes hill views. The applicant sought to replace a one-story home with a two-story house. Staff initially opposed one design, supported a smaller revision, then advised that state housing law constrained review of the house-plus-ADU proposal.

Stage	Staff recommendation	Actual action
Jan. 17, 2024	Deny without prejudice: significant hill-view impacts, despite objective zoning compliance.	Applicant-requested continuance.
July 24, 2024	Approve revised design: smaller second floor, lower design, balconies removed.	Another applicant-requested continuance.
Mar. 19, 2025	Approve house plus 355-square-foot ADU; apply objective-standard review under staff's HAA interpretation.	Planning Commission approved, 4–2.
June 17, 2025	Deny neighbors' appeal and uphold approval.	Council adopted that action and refunded the appeal fee.

Why the ADU mattered

Staff treated the house and ADU together as a housing development under the Housing Accountability Act (HAA). Staff advised that subjective view and neighborhood-character concerns could not justify denial of this compliant project. The reports still discussed view and privacy effects; those concerns did not simply disappear.

This describes the City's reasoning in this case. It does not establish that adding any ADU guarantees approval.

Sources: June 17 Council packet, PDF pp. 2–6, 17–21, 66–67, 134–136; adopted minutes printed pp. 9–10. Page references are to the 361-page packet. See page 2 for links and limits.

TESTIMONY, VIDEO LOCATORS & LIMITS

What people said—and what it establishes

Opponents: cited hill-view loss, neighborhood character, outreach and the effect of an ADU on local review. Their allegations about intent or future ADU use remain allegations.

Applicant: described outreach and revisions, disputed the opponents' account and said the ADU could offset costs or serve family, caregivers or renters. These are representations, not verified future outcomes.

Council: several members expressed frustration or reluctance. Kalani said she felt there was no choice and moved reluctantly to deny the appeal. Mattucci called it an ADU loophole while acknowledging the applicant was following state law; he opposed it. Gerson noted that staff supported an earlier design before the ADU.

Public testimony was mixed: some speakers opposed the project; others defended the applicant's right to build and the value of additional housing.

Watch the key moments

4:15:25 — Neighbor's appeal

4:28:50 — Applicant's explanation of the ADU

4:31:40 — Staff explains review constraints

4:48:23 — Mattucci: loophole and lawfulness

4:50:05 — Kalani: perceived lack of choice

10:29 — Final motion, Part 2

11:58 — Result announcement, Part 2

What remains uncertain

The automatic captions have not independently been checked against audio. They corroborate Mattucci voting no and Sheikh absent, but the written minutes contain an inconsistent numerical tally. No corrected tally is asserted here. The hearing packet also contains conflicting dimensions; it is not a verified final construction-plan set. This review does not establish completed construction, actual ADU use or improper motives.

Official Council staff packet — June 17, 2025, item 9B · Adopted Council minutes

Source archive: original packet hash, dated report extracts, full freshly downloaded English captions and verification notes are in the companion hearing-source folder.

Independent resident research. Prepared Oct. 26, 2026. This is a sourced case summary, not a City publication or independent legal opinion. Automatic-caption interpretations should be audio-checked before quoting speakers.